

Irregular verbs

Stem changes and special verbs

E -----IE

O ----UE

E----I

U----UE

Stem Changes

Stem changes are one of the most common types of irregular Spanish verb conjugations. The stem is the part of the word that's left after dropping the **-ar, -er** or **-ir** endings and there are four primary changes that can occur: **e to ie**, **o to ue**, **e to i**, and **u to ue**. These stem changes apply to all forms of conjugation except **nosotros/nosotras** and **vosotros/vosotras**.

For example:

- **Qu**erer (to want) conjugates to tú **qu**ieres.
- **P**oder (to be able to) conjugates to ella **pue**de.
- **D**ecir (to say) conjugates to ellos **d**icen.
- **J**ugar (to play) conjugates to yo **jue**go.

Special Spanish Verbs

Finally, there are a few irregular verbs that don't really seem to follow any rules. The two most common include **ser** (to be) and **ir** (to go).

Ser is conjugated as **yo soy, tú eres, usted/él/ella es, nosotros/as somos, vosotros/as sois, and ustedes/ellos/ellas son**.

Ir is conjugated as **yo voy, tú vas, usted/él/ella va, nosotros/as vamos, vosotros/as vais, and ustedes/ellos/ellas van**.